Six math clues · answer key

How a Zipper Holds Shut and Comes Apart

Find the repeated step, then use the numbers on either side of the blank to check the missing term. Welcome a spoken explanation.

Math 1 · 50

40 + 10 = 50. Each step adds 10.

Math 2 · 35

30 + 5 = 35. Each step adds 5.

Math 3 · 14

12 + 2 = 14. Each step adds 2.

Math 4 · 42

40 + 2 = 42. Each step adds 2.

Math 5 · 70

65 + 5 = 70. Each step adds 5.

Math 6 · 55

45 + 10 = 55. Each step adds 10.

Six skip-counting sequences use steps of 2, 5, and 10 within 100. The supplied numbers are for counting practice, not real zipper measurements.

Reading & writing · answer key

How a Zipper Holds Shut and Comes Apart

Reading · 1

The tape is the cloth strip sewn to the jacket, the teeth (elements) sit in a row on each tape, and the slider moves to join or part the teeth.

Reading · 2

Each tooth has a bump and a hollow, and the rows are offset, so the slider squeezes each bump into the next hollow. A lock under the slider slips between the teeth when the pull-tab is flat, so it stays still.

Reading · 3

A pin pushed fully into the box lines both rows up so the first teeth can mesh; if it is only halfway in, the rows start uneven. Stops at each end keep the slider from running off the teeth.

Writing

Accept a spoken, dictated, drawn, or written sentence that tells how one zipper part does its job.

A zipper has three main parts: the tape, the elements (teeth) and the slider. Teeth on the two tapes are offset; inside the slider the rows are pressed together at an angle so each tooth's bump seats in the next tooth's hollow, forming the chain. Many sliders are automatic-lock: when the pull-tab is released, a small pin or claw under the slider drops between the teeth. Front jacket zippers are usually open-end zippers: the insert pin must go fully into the retainer box before the slider is pulled up, or the rows start unevenly and the zipper may split or jam. Top and bottom stops keep the slider on the chain. Safety: keep fingers and loose skin clear of the slider and teeth; never zip near hair or skin, and keep small loose zipper parts away from young children.

Offer dictation: let the child say a complete thought while you write it, then invite them to add a picture, label, or sentence.

Four zipper clues

How a Zipper Holds Shut and Comes Apart

Quiz 1. How do zipper teeth hold?

Each tooth has a bump and a hollow, and the slider squeezes each bump into the next hollow.

Quiz 2. Why won't the slider slip?

With the pull-tab flat, a tiny piece under the slider slips between two teeth and holds it still.

Quiz 3. Why push the pin fully in?

With the pin fully in the box, both rows start lined up and the first teeth can mesh.

Quiz 4. What does a stop do?

Stops at each end keep the slider on the teeth.

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